# THE JOY CALENDAR

42 lesser-known days worth celebrating at work.
One simple activity for each — 7 to 12 minutes, zero prep stress.

Beyond Diwali & Christmas | No facilitator required | A learning in every activity

JOY STORIES — Building Joyful Workplaces Since 2021

WHO'S BEHIND THIS

# We build workplaces people don't want to leave.

Joy Stories is a Chennai-based team building and employee engagement company, working with HR and leadership teams since 2015. We don't just run one-off events — we design the moments, small and large, that make a workplace feel like somewhere people belong.

We work as your engagement partner: curating and managing a bench of specialist freelance facilitators across the country, so every program is matched to the right expert instead of a one-size-fits-all trainer.

01

### Team Building

Experiences that turn a group of colleagues into a team that actually trusts each other.

02

### Training

Skill-building sessions designed to stick, not just fill a calendar slot.

03

### Engagement Calendar

A steady drumbeat of moments through the year, like the ones in this PDF, so culture isn't a once-a-year event.

04

### Employee Appreciation

Recognition that feels personal, not like a form email.

05

### Employee Fun

Because a workplace people enjoy is one they don't want to leave.

06

### MICE & CSR

Meetings, incentives, conferences and give-back programmes handled end to end.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

# How to use this calendar

Every workplace already celebrates the big four — Diwali, Christmas, Pongal, Ramzan. This calendar is for the 361 other days. Small, unexpected moments, spread through the year, do more for a culture than one large event ever will.

1

### Pick a day that fits your calendar

You don't need all 42. Pick the ones that land in a quiet week, or that connect to what your team is going through right now.

2

### Read it like a school experiment

Objective, Materials, Method, Learning. Anyone on your HR or admin team can run it — no external facilitator needed.

3

### Keep it to 7–12 minutes

Short enough to fit before a stand-up or after lunch. The learning lands harder when the activity itself stays light.

4

### Say the learning out loud

The activity is the hook. The one line under “The Learning” is the point — read it out at the end, every time.

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**Want this turned into a done-for-you year-long engagement calendar for your team? Flip to the last page.**

CELEBRATE ON

**4 January**

# World Braille Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Help the team feel how much we lean on sight, and how well other senses can carry meaning instead.

## MATERIALS

Blindfolds or scarves (1 per pair) · a bowl of small mixed objects (coin, safety pin, eraser, stapler, marble) · paper and pen

## METHOD

1. Pair everyone up.
2. One person is blindfolded; the other silently hands over 5 objects, one at a time.
3. Blindfolded partner identifies each object by touch alone and calls out a guess.
4. Swap roles and repeat.
5. Reveal the objects together and compare notes.

**THE LEARNING** *We built a way to “see” without eyes. Every colleague works with a different set of strengths and constraints — the job is to find each person's way in, not expect everyone to read the room the same way.*

CELEBRATE ON

**23 January**

# National Handwriting Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show how much more a personal, hand-written line carries than the same words typed and sent.

## MATERIALS

Blank cards or paper · pens · no phones

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone to hand-write, not type, one sentence of appreciation for a colleague.
2. Swap cards silently within the group so each person receives one.
3. Let people read theirs quietly before moving on.

**THE LEARNING** *A handwritten line takes longer to write, and it lands longer too. In a world where everything can be typed and forwarded in a second, choosing the slower way is itself the message.*

CELEBRATE ON

**29 January**

# World Puzzle Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that most people solve a shared puzzle faster together than any one person solves it alone.

## MATERIALS

Two identical simple puzzles (a small jigsaw or logic puzzle) · a stopwatch

## METHOD

1. Give one volunteer a puzzle to solve alone, against the clock.
2. At the same time, give a small group the identical puzzle to solve together.
3. Compare finishing times and talk about what made the difference.

**THE LEARNING** *Working out loud is usually faster than working it out alone, even when the person alone is skilled. Most teams under-use the colleague sitting right next to them.*

CELEBRATE ON

**13 February**

# World Radio Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Rebuild the lost art of listening without a face to read — the way radio has always worked.

## MATERIALS

Chairs arranged back-to-back · one short story or update per pair (2–3 lines)

## METHOD

1. Seat pairs back-to-back.
2. One person reads or narrates their short story aloud — no gestures, since the listener can't see them.
3. Listener retells the story to the group in their own words.
4. Compare what changed in translation.

**THE LEARNING** *When we can't see a face, we listen harder to tone and word choice. A good chunk of what we send by email or chat is “radio” — it deserves the same care.*

CELEBRATE ON

**20 February**

# World Day of Social Justice

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make visible how different starting points change the outcome of an identical, “fair” competition.

## MATERIALS

Crumpled paper balls (10–15) · a bin · tape for marking throw lines at varied distances

## METHOD

1. Mark throw lines at different distances from the bin — some close, some far.
2. Assign participants to lines at random.
3. On “go,” everyone throws paper balls at the bin for 60 seconds.
4. Count baskets per person and ask who felt the game was fair.

**THE LEARNING** *The same rules applied to different starting points don't produce the same outcome. Fairness sometimes means adjusting the line, not just the rules.*

CELEBRATE ON

**1 March**

# Zero Discrimination Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show how quickly one label changes the way we treat a person, before we know anything else about them.

## MATERIALS

Sticky notes with random role labels (Manager, Intern, Vendor, New Joiner, Client) — one per participant

## METHOD

1. Stick a label on each person's back or forehead without them seeing it.
2. Everyone mingles for 5 minutes, treating each person only according to the label they can see on others — without saying the label aloud.
3. Each person guesses their own label from how they were treated.
4. Reveal and discuss.

**THE LEARNING** *We often respond to the label before we respond to the person. Noticing this is the first step to catching it before it shapes a real decision.*

CELEBRATE ON

**20 March**

# International Day of Happiness

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Prove that happiness spreads faster through a room than it can be manufactured by an event.

## MATERIALS

None — just the team, standing in a circle

## METHOD

1. Form a circle.
2. One person starts a deliberately fake laugh for 10 seconds.
3. Within moments, real laughter usually takes over the group — let it run for a minute.
4. Go around the circle and have each person name one small thing that made them smile this week.

**THE LEARNING** *Happiness spreads faster than it's manufactured. A team doesn't need a big reason to feel good together — it needs a small permission.*

CELEBRATE ON

**20 March**

# World Storytelling Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Notice how much easier information is to remember when it arrives as a story instead of a bullet list.

## MATERIALS

The same simple update, written two ways: as a plain bullet list, and as a 60-second story

## METHOD

1. Read the bullet-list version to one half of the room, and the story version to the other half, at the same time in separate corners.
2. Wait 10 minutes, doing something else.
3. Ask both groups to recall the details — compare accuracy.

**THE LEARNING** *People remember stories longer than they remember slides. The next time an update needs to stick, try telling it before presenting it.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 March**

# World Poetry Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that everyone has a poet in them when the format is small enough to fit in a coffee break.

## MATERIALS

Paper and pens · a simple structure prompt (a six-word story about the work week)

## METHOD

1. Give everyone 3 minutes to write a six-word story about their work week.
2. Collect the papers anonymously and shuffle them.
3. Read each one aloud and let the group guess who wrote it.

**THE LEARNING** *Constraint doesn't kill creativity, it focuses it. The best ideas at work often show up when someone hands us a smaller box, not a bigger one.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 March**

# World Down Syndrome Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Turn “different” into something worth pointing out, not hiding — using the global “Lots of Socks” tradition.

## MATERIALS

Just two odd, mismatched socks per person (chromosomes look like socks under a microscope — hence the tradition)

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone to wear two different, unmatched socks for the day.
2. At a short huddle, go around and have each person explain their mismatched pick.
3. Spend 5 minutes discussing one way the team benefits from people who don't “match.”

**THE LEARNING** *A team of matching socks is easy to build and boring to work in. Difference isn't a defect in the pattern — it is the pattern.*

CELEBRATE ON

**22 March**

# World Water Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Feel, physically, how small individual contributions add up to something big.

## MATERIALS

One large empty jug per team · small paper cups · a jug of water

## METHOD

1. Give each person one small cup of water.
2. Ask them to pour it into the shared jug while naming one small habit they could change this month.
3. Watch the jug fill up quickly even though each contribution was tiny.

**THE LEARNING** *One person's effort looks small. A whole team's small efforts, stacked together, look like a full jug — culture change works the same way.*

CELEBRATE ON

**2 April**

# World Autism Awareness Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Simulate sensory overload for a minute so “too much noise” becomes something felt, not just heard about.

## MATERIALS

A phone or speaker playing layered background sounds (traffic, chatter, ringing) · a simple task sheet (5 basic sums or a short instruction)

## METHOD

1. Play the layered sound mix at a moderate volume.
2. Ask participants to complete the simple task while the sound plays — most will slow down or slip up.
3. Turn the sound off and repeat the task.
4. Compare the ease and accuracy between the two rounds.

**THE LEARNING** *What looks like “not paying attention” is sometimes a mind working twice as hard to filter the world. Different doesn't mean less capable — it means a different starting condition.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 April**

# World Creativity and Innovation Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that most “impossible” problems just need a rule removed, not a genius added.

## MATERIALS

One paperclip per person · a 90-second timer

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone to list as many uses for a paperclip as they can in 90 seconds — not just holding paper.
2. Stop and tally who has the longest list.
3. Share the 2–3 wildest answers aloud.

**THE LEARNING** *Innovation rarely needs a new resource — it needs permission to look at an old one without its usual job description.*

CELEBRATE ON

**28 April**

# World Day for Safety and Health at Work

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make near-misses visible, since most serious incidents were preceded by several small, ignored ones.

## MATERIALS

Sticky notes · a wall or whiteboard

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone to silently write down one small safety shortcut or near-miss they've noticed at work — a loose cable, a rushed step, a skipped check — no names attached.
2. Post all the notes on the wall and group the similar ones together.
3. Pick the most common one and agree on one fix to try this month.

**THE LEARNING** *Most accidents were preceded by small, visible warnings that everyone quietly normalised. Noticing and naming the small stuff is the real safety system.*

CELEBRATE ON

**29 April**

# International Dance Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Use one minute of synchronised movement to build a felt sense of “we're in this together,” fast.

## MATERIALS

None, or a music player

## METHOD

1. Teach one simple 4-count move — clap, clap, step, step.
2. Have everyone repeat it together for one minute, gradually speeding up.
3. Ask how the room's energy feels compared to before.

**THE LEARNING** *Groups that move in sync, even briefly, tend to feel closer afterward. One shared minute of rhythm can do more for team spirit than an hour of icebreaker questions.*

CELEBRATE ON

**30 April**

# International Jazz Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Experience the difference between a rehearsed plan and a team that can improvise together.

## MATERIALS

None — just hands, desks, or cups for rhythm

## METHOD

1. Form a circle.
2. One person starts a simple repeating rhythm by clapping or tapping.
3. Each person joins in, one at a time, adding to the same beat without a conductor.
4. After 2 minutes, stop and ask how everyone knew when to come in.

**THE LEARNING** *The best teams, like the best jazz bands, don't need a script for every moment — they need enough trust in each other to listen and respond in real time.*

CELEBRATE ON

**1st Sunday of May**

# World Laughter Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Trigger genuine laughter through a physical exercise, not a joke.

## MATERIALS

None — open space to stand in a circle

## METHOD

1. Form a circle.
2. Lead 3 minutes of exaggerated “laughter yoga” moves — fake laughing while pointing at each other, mimed “milkshake laughter,” silent laughing with big gestures.
3. Notice it usually turns into real laughter within a minute.

**THE LEARNING** *You can act your way into a feeling faster than you can think your way into it. Sometimes the room needs a body, not a strategy.*

CELEBRATE ON

**15 May**

# International Day of Families

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Remind the team that everyone brings an invisible support system to work every day.

## MATERIALS

Index cards and pens

## METHOD

1. Ask each person to write down one name — family, friend, or chosen family — who helped them get to where they are professionally, and how.
2. Pair up and share what's on the card.
3. Invite 2–3 people to share with the wider group.

**THE LEARNING** *Nobody's career is a solo act. Recognising someone else's support system is a quiet way of respecting the whole person who shows up to work.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 May**

# World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make the case for diverse teams using taste buds instead of arguments.

## MATERIALS

4–5 small, unlabelled snacks from different regional or cultural backgrounds on the team

## METHOD

1. Lay out the snacks without labels.
2. Ask people to guess the origin of each and share any memory or word it brings up.
3. Reveal all the origins together.

**THE LEARNING** *A single cuisine gets boring fast. A single perspective in a team runs out of ideas the same way — variety is what keeps the table, and the thinking, interesting.*

CELEBRATE ON

**22 May**

# International Day for Biological Diversity

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show why a team, like an ecosystem, needs different roles to hold together under stress.

## MATERIALS

One ball of yarn or string

## METHOD

1. Stand in a circle.
2. First person holds the yarn end, names one skill they bring to the team, then throws the ball across to someone else while holding their own thread.
3. Continue until a web has formed across the circle.
4. Ask one person to gently let go — watch how the web sags.

**THE LEARNING** *A single “type” of contributor can't hold a team together — the strength is in the web, not the strand. Every role lost weakens the whole shape.*

CELEBRATE ON

**31 May**

# World No Tobacco Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that swapping the ritual around a habit is often easier than fighting the habit itself.

## MATERIALS

Small paper strips · a jar or box · pens

## METHOD

1. Each person writes one small habit they'd like to change (any habit — no one has to name tobacco specifically) and one 60-second replacement action for it, e.g. “step outside for a minute” instead of a smoke break.
2. Drop the strips into the jar.
3. Everyone draws someone else's strip and does that 60-second replacement action together, right now.

**THE LEARNING** *We rarely quit a habit outright — we replace the ritual around it. A team's job is to make the swap easy, not just point at the habit.*

CELEBRATE ON

**1 June**

# Global Day of Parents

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Let colleagues see a familiar coworker through a completely different lens — as someone's child.

## MATERIALS

None required

## METHOD

1. In small groups, ask each person to share one piece of advice a parent or guardian gave them that still shows up in how they work today.
2. Let a few volunteers share with the wider group.

**THE LEARNING** *Everyone carries an inherited playbook to work, often without realising it. Naming it out loud makes it easier to keep what helps and question what doesn't.*

CELEBRATE ON

**5 June**

# World Environment Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make “small individual choices add up” visible and countable.

## MATERIALS

A whiteboard or flip chart, marker

## METHOD

1. Ask each person to name one everyday work habit that creates waste — printouts, an AC left running, single-use cups.
2. Tally repeats on the board live.
3. Circle the most common one and agree on one fix to try for 30 days.

**THE LEARNING** *Most environmental habits at work aren't dramatic — they're default settings nobody's questioned. A team can change a default faster than one person can change a habit alone.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 June**

# International Day of Yoga

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Use one minute of stillness to show what an actual reset feels like mid-workday.

## MATERIALS

Chairs, nothing else

## METHOD

1. Seated, guide 60 seconds of slow breathing — 4 counts in, hold 4, out 4.
2. Follow with 2 minutes of simple seated stretches — neck rolls, shoulder shrugs, wrist circles.
3. Ask how the room's energy compares to before.

**THE LEARNING** *A reset doesn't need 60 minutes on a mat. A deliberate 3-minute pause between meetings changes the quality of the next hour more than people expect.*

CELEBRATE ON

**26 June**

# International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Demonstrate how quickly coordination and judgement break down under a distraction.

## MATERIALS

None — just a simple 4-step clap pattern

## METHOD

1. Teach the group a simple 4-step clapping pattern and let them practise it cleanly.
2. Add a distraction: everyone must count backwards from 20 out loud while clapping the same pattern.
3. Watch accuracy fall and discuss why.

**THE LEARNING** *Anything that hijacks focus — a substance, a distraction, or plain overload — quietly breaks coordination and judgement before anyone notices. Protecting focus is protecting safety.*

CELEBRATE ON

**27 June**

# World Sunglasses Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Feel firsthand how a filter changes what looks true — and how obvious that becomes only once it's removed.

## MATERIALS

A few pairs of strongly tinted sunglasses (yellow or blue works well) · a set of coloured objects or swatches (blue, green, yellow, red)

## METHOD

1. Ask a few volunteers to put on the tinted glasses.
2. With the glasses still on, they sort or name the coloured objects as they perceive them.
3. Reveal the true colours once the glasses come off.
4. Discuss how confidently wrong the guesses were.

**THE LEARNING** *A strong-enough filter — a mood, an assumption, a first impression — makes us confidently wrong. Take the glasses off before you judge what's in front of you.*

CELEBRATE ON

**1 July**

# National Doctors' Day (India)

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Build empathy for what it takes to stay calm when someone else's crisis is your daily routine.

## MATERIALS

A short “worried patient” scenario card per pair · a stopwatch

## METHOD

1. In pairs, one person plays a panicked “patient” describing a problem dramatically for 60 seconds.
2. The other must respond calmly, ask two clarifying questions, and offer one reassuring next step — without matching the panic.
3. Swap roles and repeat.

**THE LEARNING** *Staying calm when someone else is not is a skill, not a personality trait — and it's exactly what makes a good doctor, and a good manager, trusted in a crisis.*

CELEBRATE ON

**30 July**

# International Day of Friendship

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Turn “work friends” into something more deliberate than seating charts.

## MATERIALS

Small folded paper slips with icebreaker questions · a bowl or hat

## METHOD

1. Everyone picks a slip with a question (e.g. “What's a hobby not many people know you have?”).
2. Find a colleague you don't usually work with and ask/answer it together in 2 minutes.
3. Repeat with 2–3 more slips and different people.

**THE LEARNING** *Most workplace friendships form by proximity, not choice. A few structured minutes can do in a week what six months at the same lunch table won't.*

CELEBRATE ON

**13 August**

# International Left Handers Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Physically experience what it's like when the default setup wasn't built for you.

## MATERIALS

Regular right-handed scissors · paper with a drawn shape to cut · pens

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone, including left-handers, to write their name and cut out the shape using only their non-dominant hand.
2. Compare the results and the frustration levels across the room.

**THE LEARNING** *Tools and systems are rarely neutral — they're usually built for the majority by default. Left-handers live this daily; it's worth asking who else is quietly working around our “default” setup.*

CELEBRATE ON

**19 August**

# World Photography Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show how the same moment tells a different story depending on who's framing it.

## MATERIALS

Phone cameras · one shared object or corner of the office as the subject

## METHOD

1. Give everyone 3 minutes to photograph the same object or spot, their own way.
2. Display all the photos side by side.
3. Discuss how differently the “same” thing looks through each lens.

**THE LEARNING** *Two people looking at the same project, problem, or meeting rarely see the same frame. Asking “what did you notice?” surfaces the version you'd have missed.*

CELEBRATE ON

**8 September**

# International Literacy Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Feel, for a moment, the extra effort of navigating a workplace when reading itself is the hard part.

## MATERIALS

A simple instruction sheet with the words scrambled, reversed, or in an unfamiliar script

## METHOD

1. Hand out the scrambled instruction sheet.
2. Give the group 2 minutes to try to complete a small task using only that sheet.
3. Discuss what the frustration felt like.

**THE LEARNING** *Most workplaces are designed assuming everyone reads as fast and as easily as we do. A little patience, and a lot of plain language, includes more people than we realise.*

CELEBRATE ON

**15 September**

# National Engineers' Day (India)

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that constraints, not free rein, are what force the best engineering thinking.

## MATERIALS

10 sheets of A4 paper and 30cm of tape per team of 3–4 · a small weight (a phone or a stack of coins)

## METHOD

1. In 7 minutes, teams build the tallest free-standing paper tower using only the paper and tape given.
2. The tower must hold the weight balanced at the top for 10 seconds.
3. Measure and test every team's tower together at the end.

**THE LEARNING** *Every real constraint — budget, time, material — is a design brief in disguise. The best engineers, and the best teams, treat limits as the start of a solution, not the end of one.*

CELEBRATE ON

**21 September**

# International Day of Peace

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Practice de-escalating a disagreement using words instead of winning it.

## MATERIALS

A short, mildly contentious debate topic per pair (tea vs. coffee, WFH vs. office, and similar low-stakes topics)

## METHOD

1. In pairs, one person argues their side for 60 seconds.
2. The other person's only job is to reflect back what they heard, calmly and without interrupting, before offering their own view.
3. Swap roles and repeat with a new topic.

**THE LEARNING** *Most disagreements de-escalate the moment one person feels genuinely heard. Reflecting before responding is a small habit with an outsized effect — at work and everywhere else.*

CELEBRATE ON

**29 September**

# World Heart Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make the link between physical heart rate and emotional state visible, through play rather than a lecture.

## MATERIALS

None — just open space

## METHOD

1. Take resting pulse for 15 seconds and multiply by 4.
2. Do 60 seconds of a fun, high-energy activity — fast claps, jumping jacks, or a quick relay.
3. Take pulse again immediately after and compare the numbers.

**THE LEARNING** *The heart responds to what we do and how we feel, instantly and honestly. A team that laughs, moves and connects regularly isn't just happier — it's measurably healthier.*

CELEBRATE ON

**1 October**

# International Coffee Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Use a shared ritual to open up conversations that don't usually happen at desks.

## MATERIALS

Coffee or tea for everyone · printed conversation-starter cards

## METHOD

1. Over a 10-minute break, everyone picks up a drink and a conversation card (e.g. “What's a small work win from this month nobody noticed?”).
2. Find someone new to talk to before sitting back down.

**THE LEARNING** *The best ideas and honest feedback often show up near a coffee machine, not in a meeting room. Rituals like this aren't a break from work — they're where a lot of real work happens.*

CELEBRATE ON

**10 October**

# World Mental Health Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Normalise naming how the week has actually felt, in a low-pressure way, with no advice attached.

## MATERIALS

None, or a simple printed weather scale (sunny / cloudy / stormy / foggy)

## METHOD

1. Go around the group and ask each person to describe their week in one weather word — sunny, cloudy, stormy or foggy.
2. No one comments, fixes, or gives advice — the group just listens and nods.
3. Close by reminding the team where to go for a private, individual conversation if a “stormy” week needs more than a nod (your EAP or HR contact).

**THE LEARNING** *A team doesn't need every answer to a hard week — it needs a place where “stormy” is safe to say out loud. Naming a feeling, without demanding a fix, is the whole point. If it comes up often for the same person, that's a cue for a private check-in, not a group one.*

CELEBRATE ON

**Last Wednesday of October**

# World Sustainability Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show how individual daily choices, tracked for just one hour, reveal a footprint bigger than anyone expects.

## MATERIALS

A simple tally sheet and pens

## METHOD

1. Ask everyone to jot down, over the next hour, every single-use item they touch — cups, wrappers, printed pages.
2. At the end of the hour, add up the room's total together.
3. Pick one item on the list to cut down on as a team this month.

**THE LEARNING** *A sustainability audit doesn't need a consultant to start, it needs one honest hour of counting. Most teams are surprised by their own total — and that surprise is where the change begins.*

CELEBRATE ON

**31 October**

# World Magic Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Show that trust, like a good magic trick, is built on a well-managed reveal.

## MATERIALS

One or two simple, easy-to-learn magic tricks with clear instructions and props

## METHOD

1. Have a volunteer or facilitator perform 2–3 short tricks for the group, building genuine surprise.
2. Then teach the group exactly how one trick works, showing how simple the mechanism really was.
3. Ask how it felt to go from “wow” to “oh, that's it?”

**THE LEARNING** *Most relationships and negotiations work the same way — the wow comes from what's withheld, and the trust comes from what's revealed afterward, at the right moment.*

CELEBRATE ON

**2nd Sunday of November**

# International Tongue Twister Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Use shared, low-stakes failure to build comfort with imperfection in front of others.

## MATERIALS

A list of 5 tongue twisters, easy to hard, printed out

## METHOD

1. Go around the group, each person attempts a tongue twister three times fast.
2. Celebrate the stumbles loudly, not just the clean attempts.

**THE LEARNING** *A team that can laugh at a fumbled sentence together will find it much easier to admit a fumbled project. Practising small, safe failure builds the muscle for the big, real one.*

CELEBRATE ON

**13 November**

# World Kindness Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make kindness an action with a visible trail, not just a feeling.

## MATERIALS

Small note cards and pens

## METHOD

1. Each person writes one specific, genuine appreciation note to a colleague — not their manager.
2. Hand-deliver the note in person, within the day.

**THE LEARNING** *Kindness that stays a thought never lands. The specific, delivered version — even one sentence — is what people remember months later.*

CELEBRATE ON

**3 December**

# International Day of Persons with Disabilities

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Build a felt sense of how much extra effort a small barrier creates, and how solvable most barriers are.

## MATERIALS

One arm sling or tied-back sleeve per volunteer · everyday office items (a bottle, a file, a keyboard)

## METHOD

1. Ask volunteers to complete 2–3 simple office tasks with one arm restricted for 3 minutes.
2. Discuss what made it harder and what single change would have helped most.

**THE LEARNING** *Most accessibility fixes are small and cheap once you know the exact friction point. The hard part is remembering to ask what that point is before someone has to tell you.*

CELEBRATE ON

**10 December**

# Human Rights Day

7–12 MIN · TEAM ACTIVITY

## OBJECTIVE

Make the abstract idea of “rights” concrete by having the team define their own, at work.

## MATERIALS

Flip chart and markers

## METHOD

1. In 5 minutes, the team brainstorms what every person on the team is entitled to at work — to be heard, to make mistakes, to say no.
2. Pick the group's top 3.
3. Read them aloud together to close the session.

**THE LEARNING** *Rights that are written down and said aloud get honoured more often than the ones everyone assumes are “obviously” true. Naming them is how a team holds itself accountable.*

TRUSTED BY TEAMS AT

# Some of the rooms we've made joyful.

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LET'S TALK

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